



Book explores Edna O'Brien's twilight years

新书探寻埃德娜·奥布莱恩的暮年岁月

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

After visiting his dying mother in London, Carlo Gébler returned to his **rural** home in Northern Ireland one night and **encountered** a **hedgehog** sitting on the **doormat**. A thought **bubbled up**: his mother had died and been **reincarnated** as this **woodland** creature.

在伦敦探望弥留之际的母亲后，卡洛·盖伯勒一天夜里回到他在北爱尔兰的乡下的家中，碰见一只刺猬坐在门垫上。一个念头冒了出来：母亲已经去世，转世成了这只林中生灵。

【 Para.2 】

In fact, his mother, the novelist Edna O'Brien, was still alive, but his mind insisted **otherwise**. "At that moment that's what I believed. And then of course I stopped believing it because I knew it wasn't true." When O'Brien died days later in July 2024, at the age of 93, the **literary**

文章导读：

埃德娜·奥布莱恩的临终前后。其子盖伯勒出版编年记录：《无人告诉你：奥布莱恩的最后岁月》。埃德娜·奥布莱恩的生平、作品中对女性权利与性别议题的反映及其遭受的敌意评论。奥布莱恩死后获得赞誉印证了“死亡是极好的职业发展策略”这一病态玩笑。盖伯勒的丧亲之痛与书写回忆录的冲动。盖伯勒的死亡观、临终陪伴伦理与写作疗愈。

twilight n. /'twaɪlaɪt/ the final stage or period of something; the time after sunset 暮年；黄昏；晚期

I knew him when he was in the **twilight** of his career.

我在他职业生涯的晚期才认识他。[反义词: dawn n. 黎明；破晓]

rural adj. /'rʊərəl/ relating to the countryside rather than a town or city 乡村的，农村的 【考研大纲词汇】

She prefers **rural** life to city life.

比起城市生活，她更喜欢乡村生活。

encounter v. /ɪn'kaʊntə(r)/ to meet or experience something, especially unexpectedly 遇到，遭遇；偶然碰到 【考研大纲词汇】

We **encountered** a violent storm on the way home.

我们在回家途中遭遇了一场猛烈的暴风雨。

hedgehog n. /'hedʒhɒg/ a small brown animal with sharp spines on its back 刺猬

The **hedgehog** curled up when we approached.

我们走近时，刺猬蜷缩了起来。

doormat n. /'dɔːmæt/ a mat placed at a door for wiping dirt from shoes 门垫，门口擦鞋垫

He left his muddy boots on the **doormat**.

他把沾满泥的靴子留在了门垫上。

bubble v. /'bʌbəl / (~up) (of a feeling or thought) to rise or appear gradually 涌起，冒出；起泡 【考研大纲词汇】

A feeling of excitement **bubbled up** inside him.

一种兴奋感在他心中涌起。

reincarnate v. /'riːn'kɑːneɪt/ to be born again in another body after death 使转世；转世投胎

The novel imagines that a dead king could **reincarnate** as a common farmer.

这部小说想象一位死去的国王可能转世为一个普通农夫。

woodland n. /'wʊdlənd/ land covered with trees 林地，树林

The children got lost in the dense **woodland**.

孩子们在茂密的林地中迷路了。[grassland n. 草原；牧场；草地]

world **mourned** the passing of a **singular** voice who had **scandalised** her native Ireland with **depictions** of female **sexuality** and **blazed** a **trail** for Irish writers.

事实上，他的母亲、小说家埃德娜·奥布莱恩还活着，但他的头脑却执意认为并非如此。“那一刻，我就是这么相信的。后来当然不再相信了，因为我知道那不是真的。”几天后，奥布莱恩于2024年7月去世，享年93岁。文学界哀悼这位独特声音的逝去——她对女性性欲的描写令故乡爱尔兰哗然，也为爱尔兰作家开辟了道路。

【 Para.3 】

Now her son has produced a **chronicle** of O'Brien's final years, a twilight marked by her struggle to keep working despite illness and **frailty**, and of the impact of her death on his own life. Published this Friday, No One Tells You: The Last Years of Edna O'Brien documents the writer's doomed battle to complete a final book about TS Eliot as age and **infirmity sapped** her powers.

如今，她的儿子写出了一部编年史，记录奥布莱恩的最后岁月，那是一段尽管疾病缠身、身体虚弱仍努力继续工作的暮年时光，同时也记录了她的去世对他自己生活的影响。本周五出版的《无人告诉你：埃德娜·奥布莱恩的最后岁月》记录了这位作家在年老体衰、精力被消磨之际，为完成一部关于T.S.艾略特的最后著作而进行的一场注定失败的挣扎。

【 Para.4 】

O'Brien escaped a **stifling** and **conservative upbringing** in County Clare by moving to Dublin and **eloping** with

otherwise adv. /'ʌðə waɪz/ in a different way or in different circumstances 否则；在其他情况下 【考研大纲词汇】

He is usually very patient, but **otherwise** he can be quite strict.

他通常很有耐心，但在其他情况下也可能相当严格。[likewise adv. 同样地；也，而且]

literary adj. /'lɪtərəri/ relating to literature or books 文学的；文学作品的 【考研大纲词汇】

The award recognizes outstanding **literary** achievements from young writers.

该奖项表彰年轻作家的杰出文学成就。[近：literally adv. 逐字地；照字面地；确实地]

mourn v. /mɔ:n/ to feel and express great sadness because someone has died 哀悼；为……的逝世感到悲痛 【考研大纲词汇】

The whole community gathered to **mourn** the loss of the beloved teacher.

整个社区聚集在一起，哀悼那位深受爱戴的老师的离世。

singular adj. /'sɪŋɡjələ/ very unusual or special, especially in a way that makes someone or something stand out 独特的；非凡的 【考研大纲词汇】

She has a **singular** talent for making complex ideas easy to understand.

她有一种非凡的才能，能把复杂的思想讲得很容易理解。

scandalise v. /'skændəlaɪz/ to shock or offend people because something is considered morally or socially unacceptable （不道德的行为）使震惊，使反感，使愤慨

The politician's careless remarks **scandalised** many members of the public.

那位政治人物轻率的言论令许多公众感到震惊和愤慨

depiction n. /dɪ'pɪkʃən/ a description or representation of someone or something in words, pictures, or other forms 描绘；描述；刻画

The film offers a realistic **depiction** of life in a small fishing village. 这部电影真实地描绘了一个小渔村的生活。

sexuality n. /'sekʃu'æləti/ the feelings, behavior, and identity related to sexual attraction and relationships 性；性取向；性特征

The novel explores how people develop their understanding of **sexuality** as they grow older.

这部小说探讨了人们随着年龄增长如何逐渐认识自己的性特征和性取向。

blaze v. /bleɪz/ to create a new path or make it easier for others to follow by being the first to do something 开辟道路；闯出新路 【考研大纲词汇】

She **blazed** a trail for women in a field that had long been dominated by men.

她为女性在一个长期由男性主导的领域中开辟了道路。

trail n. /treɪl/ a path or route, especially one that others can follow 小路；路线；（比喻）道路 【考研大纲词汇】

The scientist's discovery opened a new **trail** for future researchers to follow.

这位科学家的发现为未来的研究人员开辟了一条新的道路。

Ernest Gébler, an Irish-Czech writer, to England, where they raised two sons, Carlo and Sasha, before divorcing. The Country Girls, published in 1960, established her **reputation**, launching her image as a **glamorous** public **persona** in London: a **convent**-educated **rebel** who **befriended** Hollywood stars while writing novels, **biographies**, plays and poetry.

奥布莱恩逃离了克莱尔郡令人窒息、保守的成长环境：她搬到都柏林，并与爱尔兰-捷克作家欧内斯特·盖伯勒私奔到英格兰，在那里养育了两个儿子，卡洛和萨沙，后来离婚。1960年出版的《乡村女孩》奠定了她的声誉，塑造了她在伦敦魅力四射的公众形象：一个受过修道院教育的反叛者，在写小说、传记、戏剧和诗歌的同时，还与好莱坞明星交朋友。

【 Para.5 】

Female desire and subversion **populated** her fiction decades before Ireland liberalised and legalised divorce, same-sex marriage and abortion, but that did not entitle Irish people to “co-opt” her memory for political ends, said Gébler. “In Ireland people want a narrative which emphasises the **progressive** journey, as if she planned all the political progress on the back of an envelope.

早在在爱尔兰对离婚、同性婚姻和堕胎放宽限制并予以合法化的几十年前，女性欲望与颠覆就已充斥她的小说，但盖伯勒说，这并不赋予爱尔兰人为了政治目的“挪用”她记忆的权利。“在爱尔兰，人们想要一种强调进步历程的叙事，就好像她匆匆策划了所有政治进步一样。

chronicle n. /'krɒnɪkəl/ a written record of events in the order in which they happened 编年史，记事录

The documentary serves as a **chronicle** of the civil rights movement. 这部纪录片是民权运动的编年记录。

frailty n. /'freɪlti/ the condition of being physically weak and delicate, especially because of old age or illness 虚弱，衰弱

Despite her **frailty**, she continued to care for her garden.

尽管身体虚弱，她仍继续照料自己的花园。[fragile adj. 脆弱的]

infirmity n. /ɪn'fɜ:məti/ physical weakness or illness, especially in old age 体弱，虚弱；疾病

She refused to let her **infirmity** stop her from pursuing her studies. 她不愿让体弱阻止自己继续学业。

sap v. /sæp/ to gradually weaken someone's strength, energy, or confidence 逐渐削弱，消耗

Worry can **sap** your energy over time.

会逐渐消耗你的精力。

stifling adj. /'staɪflɪŋ/ preventing free expression or development; very hot and airless 令人窒息的；压抑的

The **stifling** rules at the boarding school made students feel trapped. 寄宿学校令人窒息的规则让学生感到被困。

conservative adj. /kən'sɜ:vətɪv/ not liking change or new ideas; traditional 保守的，守旧的 【考研大纲词汇】

Her **conservative** parents disapproved of her unconventional career choice.

她保守的父母不赞成她非传统的职业选择。

upbringing n. /'ʌpbriŋɪŋ/ the way a child is treated and educated while growing up 教养，抚养

A loving **upbringing** can help a child feel secure.

充满爱的教养能帮助孩子感到安全。[bring someone up

Phrasal verb 养育，抚养；教养]

elope v. /'i:ləʊp/ to run away secretly with a lover, especially to get married 私奔

They **eloped** to Las Vegas without telling anyone.

他们没告诉任何人就私奔到拉斯维加斯结婚了。

reputation n. /'repjə'teɪʃən/ the belief or opinion that people generally have about someone or something 名声，声誉 【考研大纲词汇】

The school has a **reputation** for academic excellence.

这所学校以学术卓越闻名。

glamorous adj. /'glæməərəs/ attractive and exciting in a way associated with wealth, fame, or fashion 迷人的，光鲜的

The actress looked **glamorous** in her evening gown.

那位女演员穿着晚礼服，光彩照人。

persona n. /pə'səʊnə/ the image or character that someone presents to other people 形象，人格面具

The politician's friendly **persona** hid his ruthless ambition. 那位政客友好的形象掩盖了他冷酷的野心。

【 Para.6 】

Gébler said his mother **endured** many **hostile** reviews, initially by critics who deemed her work “**unseemly**” and later by others who disliked her **forays** into the lives of historical figures such as James Joyce’s muse and wife, Nora Barnacle, or the kidnapping of girls in Nigeria. “Her fiction changed its **register**, but the world isn’t very **sympathetic** to that. It’s kind of: ‘It’s not your **gig**, madam.’ ”

盖伯勒说，母亲忍受了许多敌意评论，起初是批评者认为她的作品“不成体统”，后来是另一些人，他们不喜欢她涉足历史人物生活，如乔伊斯的缪斯兼妻子诺拉·巴纳克尔，或是尼日利亚女孩遭绑架事件。“她的小说改变了调性，但世界对此并不太宽容。那意思有点像：‘这不是你该干的事，夫人。’”

【 Para.7 】

The **posthumous acclaim** for his mother **validated** the **morbid** joke about death being a great career move, said Gébler. “A living writer is sometimes **overlooked** because there’s so much other noise, but death is an even bigger noise, so you can get people’s distracted attention.”

盖伯勒说，母亲去世后获得的赞誉印证了那个病态的玩笑：死亡是一次极好的职业发展策略。“在世的作家有时会被忽视，因为其他噪音太多，但死亡是更大的噪音，于是你就能吸引到人们分散的注意力。”

【 Para.8 】

For Gébler, however, her passing brought loss, **confusion** and **dread**. “The awful thing about a parent’s death is that

convent n. /'kɒnvənt/ a place where nuns live and work, or a school run by nuns 女修道院；修道院学校

She was educated at a **convent** in the countryside.
她在乡间的一所修道院学校接受教育。

rebel n. /'rebəl/ a person who refuses to obey authority or follow accepted rules 反叛者，叛逆者 【考研大纲词汇】

As a teenager, he was a **rebel** who questioned everything.
青少年时，他是个质疑一切的反叛者。

befriend v. /bɪ'frend/ to become friendly with someone, especially to help or support them 与...交朋友；帮助

A kind neighbor **befriended** the lonely old man.
一位善良的邻居与那位孤独的老人交朋友。

biography n. /baɪ'ɒɡrəfi/ a book or account of someone’s life written by another person 传记 【考研大纲词汇】

She read a **biography** of a famous artist.
她读了一本著名艺术家的传记。

populate v. /'pɒpjəleɪt/ to fill or be present in large numbers throughout a place or thing 充斥，充满；居住于

Tourists **populate** the beaches every summer.
每年夏天游客挤满这些海滩。

progressive adj. /prə'ɡresɪv/ favoring new ideas, social change, or reform; moving forward 进步的，先进的；渐进的 【考研大纲词汇】

She is known for her **progressive** views on education.
她以在教育方面的进步观点而闻名。

endure v. /ɪn'dʒʊə(r)/ to suffer something painful or difficult patiently 忍受，忍耐 【考研大纲词汇】

She **endured** years of criticism before her talent was recognized.
她忍受了多年的批评，直到她的才华得到认可。

hostile adj. /'hɒstail/ showing strong dislike or opposition 敌意的，不友好的 【考研大纲词汇】

The proposal met with a **hostile** reception from local residents.

该提议遭到当地居民的敌意对待。[形近反义：hospitable adj. 好客的、热情待人的]

unseemly adj. /ʌn'si:mli/ not proper, polite, or suitable 不体面的，不得体的

His **unseemly** behavior at the dinner embarrassed everyone.
他在晚宴上不得体的行为让所有人难堪。

foray n. /'fɒreɪ/ a short attempt to become involved in a new area or activity 涉足，尝试

Her first **foray** into politics ended in defeat.
她首次涉足政治以失败告终。

register n. /'redʒɪstə(r)/ a particular range, style, or level of language or expression 语域，语体风格；调性

People chatting at a party will usually be talking in (an) informal **register**.
人们在聚会上聊天通常都是用非正式语体。

you move up to the **cliff edge**. Once they're gone, you know you're next. And then you start to have all sorts of terrible thoughts. Why did I do this to my children? They didn't ask to be born and then they too are going to die."

然而，对盖伯勒来说，她的去世带来了失落、困惑和恐惧。“父母去世的可怕之处在于，你逼近了悬崖边缘。他们一走，你就知道下一个是你。然后你开始产生各种可怕的想法。我为什么要这样对我的孩子？他们并没有要求被生下来，而他们同样也会死去。”

【 Para.9 】

The **impulse** to write the **memoir** came in her final weeks as he **shuttled** from his home in County Fermanagh to tend her in London. "The unconscious is very patient and very clever, and it always waits until the right moment. And then comes this very strong sense: right, this is what I must write."

写这本回忆录的冲动出现在她生命的最后几周，当时他在弗马纳郡的家与伦敦之间往返奔波，去照料她。

“潜意识非常有耐心，也非常聪明，它总是等到合适的时机。然后一种非常强烈的感觉就会浮现：对，这就是我必须写下来的。”

【 Para.10 】

The finality of death was **unconscionable**, said Gébler. "There's no way around the fact: one's own **extinction** is disgusting to **contemplate**, as is the extinction of other people."

盖伯勒说，死亡的终局性令人无法接受。“无法回避的事实是：设想自己的消亡令人厌恶，他人的消亡亦

sympathetic adj. /ˌsɪmpəˈθetɪk/ showing agreement, approval, or support 赞同的，支持的；同情的 【考研大纲词汇】

The committee was **sympathetic** to our request for funding. 委员会赞同我们的资金申请。

gig n. /ɡɪɡ/ a job, role, or task, especially one that suits a person 工作，差事

Teaching online turned out to be a perfect **gig** for her. 在线教学对她来说是一份完美的工作。

posthumous adj. /ˈpɒstʃʊməs/ happening or given after someone's death 死后的，身后的

The artist received **posthumous** recognition when a gallery exhibited his paintings after his death.

这位艺术家去世后，一家画廊展出了他的画作，使他获得了身后的认可。

acclaim n. /əˈkleɪm/ public praise and approval 赞誉，喝彩 【考研大纲词汇】

Her novel won critical **acclaim** around the world. 她的小说赢得了世界各地评论界的赞誉。

validate v. /ˈvælɪdeɪt/ to prove that something is true or correct 证实，确认

The experiment's results **validated** the scientist's original theory. 实验结果证实了这位科学家最初的理论。

morbid adj. /ˈmɔːbɪd/ (disapproving) too interested in unpleasant subjects, especially death (尤指对死亡等) 病态的，着迷的

He has a **morbid** fascination with death and disaster. 他对死亡和灾难有一种病态的兴趣。

overlook v. /ˌəʊvəˈlʊk/ to fail to notice or give attention to something 忽视，忽略 【考研大纲词汇】

The manager **overlooked** her contribution and promoted someone else. 经理忽视了她的贡献，提拔了别人。

confusion n. /kənˈfjuːʒən/ a state of not understanding what is happening or what to do 困惑，迷惑；混乱 【考研大纲词汇】

There was widespread **confusion** about the new rules. 人们对于新规定普遍感到困惑。

dread n. /dred/ a feeling of great fear or worry about something that may happen 恐惧，惧怕；担忧 【考研大纲词汇】

He felt a deep **dread** before the operation. 手术前他感到深深的恐惧。

cliff n. /klɪf/ a high steep rock face, especially at the edge of the sea or a mountain 悬崖，峭壁 【考研大纲词汇】

They walked carefully along the **cliff** path. 他们沿着悬崖小路小心行走。

edge n. /edʒ/ the outer or furthest point of something, especially where it ends or meets another surface 边缘，边沿 【考研大纲词汇】

She sat on the **edge** of the bed. 她坐在床边。

然。”

【 Para.11 】

Those close to a dying person had an **obligation** to let them feel seen and heard, he said. “Human being to human being, you listen. That’s your most important **duty**.”

他说，临终者的亲近之人有义务让他们感到自己被看见、被听见。“作为一个人，面对另一个人，你要倾听。那是你最重要的责任。”

【 Para.12 】

His other advice is to impose order on the chaos of loss by writing about it, whether in **scribbled** notes or a published book. “If you just let things **fester** in the **basement** of the **psyche**, they just get bigger and darker and huger and more and more terrible. You have to get it up into the light. And then you can come to some sort of **accommodation** with it, or a **truce**.”

他的另一个建议是，通过书写，来为丧亲之痛带来的混乱建立秩序，无论是潦草笔记还是出版成书。“如果你任由事情在心灵的地下室里溃烂，它们只会变得更大、更黑暗、更臃肿、越来越可怕。你必须把它带到光亮中。然后你才能与它达成某种和解，或休战。”

impulse n. /'ɪmpʌls/ a sudden strong urge or desire to do something 冲动；突然的念头 【考研大纲词汇】

She bought the expensive dress on **impulse**.

她一时冲动买下了那条昂贵的连衣裙。

memoir n. /'memwɑːr/ a book or other piece of writing based on the writer's personal knowledge of famous people, places, or events 传记，传略

The former soldier published a **memoir** about his years at war. 那位前士兵出版了一本关于他战争岁月的传记。

shuttle v. /'ʃʌtl/ to travel regularly between two places, especially over a short distance 往返穿梭，频繁往返【考研大纲词汇】

He **shuttles** between Shanghai and New York for work every week. 他每周往返于上海和纽约之间工作。

unconscionable adj. /ʌn'kɒnʃənəbəl/ not right or reasonable; morally unacceptable 道德上不可接受的

To make people feel shame or guilt for being ill is **unconscionable**.

让人们因为生病而感到羞耻和负疚是不道德的。[conscience n. 良心]

extinction n. /ɪk'stɪŋkʃn/ the state of no longer existing or being completely destroyed 灭绝，消亡

Many birds are threatened with **extinction**.

许多鸟类面临灭绝威胁。

contemplate v. /'kɒntəmpleɪt/ to think about something seriously and for a long time 沉思，考虑；思量 【考研大纲词汇】

He **contemplated** moving to another country.

他考虑过搬到另一个国家。

obligation n. /'ɒblɪ'geɪʃn/ a moral or legal requirement that you must fulfil 义务，责任 【考研大纲词汇】

Parents have an **obligation** to provide for their children. 父母有义务抚养孩子。

duty n. /'djuːti/ something you must do because it is morally or legally right; a responsibility 责任，义务，职责

It is your **duty** to report the accident to the police.

你有责任向警方报告这起事故。

scribble v. /'skribəl/ to write or draw something quickly or carelessly 匆匆地写；乱涂乱画

The baby's just **scribbled** all over my new dictionary!

这个孩子刚才在我的新词典上乱涂乱画！

fester v. /'festər/ to become worse, more bitter, or more painful over time, especially because of being ignored 溃烂；恶化；郁积

Resentment can **fester** if it is never discussed.

怨恨如果从不沟通就会不断郁积。

basement n. /'beɪsmənt/ a part of a building that is below ground level 地下室 【考研大纲词汇】

The old boxes were left in the **basement** for years.

那些旧箱子在地下室放了好多年。

句子分析：

主句

主语：The Country Girls；后置定语：published in 1960；谓语：established；宾语：her reputation；结果状语：launching her image as ... and poetry

结果状语

launching her image as a glamorous public persona in London: (同位语) a convent-educated rebel who befriended Hollywood stars while writing novels, biographies, plays and poetry
同位语 (说明 persona 的具体内容)

a convent-educated rebel (定语从句)：who befriended Hollywood stars while writing novels, biographies, plays and poetry
定语从句 (修饰 a convent-educated rebel)

主语：who；谓语：befriended；宾语：Hollywood stars；时间状语：while writing novels, biographies, plays and poetry

➤ 写作积累

(para.5) Female desire and subversion populated her fiction decades before Ireland liberalised and legalised divorce, same-sex marriage and abortion, but that did not entitle Irish people to “co-opt” her memory for political ends, said Gébler. 早在爱尔兰对离婚、同性婚姻和堕胎放宽限制并予以合法化的几十年前，女性欲望与颠覆就已充斥她的小说，但盖伯勒说，这并不赋予爱尔兰人为了政治目的“挪用”她记忆的权利。

co-opt 表示“to include someone in something, often against their will” 中文为“强行拉进；拉拢，笼络”，例如：Whether they liked it or not, local people were co-opted into the victory parade. 不管愿不愿意，当地人都被强拉参加了胜利大游行。

co- 是前缀，核心含义是 with / together，即“共同、一起、相互、联合”。

其他以 “co-” 为前缀的实用词汇：

co-worker n. a person who you work with, especially someone with a similar job or level of responsibility 同事，同僚；(尤指) 共同工作者，帮手

I asked my co-worker to help me prepare for the meeting. 我请我的同事帮我准备会议。

co-exist n. to live or exist together at the same time or in the same place 共生；共处；共存

He does not believe that modern medicine can co-exist with faith-healing. 他不相信现代医学能与信仰疗法共存。

coordinate v. to make many different things work effectively as a whole 协调；使相配合

We need someone to coordinate the whole campaign. 我们需要有人来协调整个活动。

cohere v. to unite or to hold together as a unit 使结合为一体；凝结；粘和

His vision is of a world that coheres through human connection rather than rules. 他构想中的世界是通过人际关系而非规章制度聚集在一起的。

psyche n. /'saɪki/ the mind, soul, or spirit of a person 心灵，心理，精神

Music can have a powerful effect on the human **psyche**.

音乐能对人的心灵产生强大影响。

accommodation n. /ə,kəmə'deɪʃən/ a compromise or agreement that allows people to deal with a difficult situation 和解，妥协；适应 【考研大纲词汇】

They reached an **accommodation** that satisfied both sides. 他们达成了一项令双方都满意的妥协。

truce n. /tru:s/ an agreement between enemies or opponents to stop fighting or arguing for a certain time 停战，休战；暂时和解

The arguing couple called a **truce** for the sake of the children. 那对争吵的夫妇为了孩子暂时休战。 [truth n. 真相]

➤ 今日句子分析

主句

The Country Girls, published in 1960, established her

主语

后置定语

谓语

reputation, launching her image as ... and poetry.

宾语

结果状语

结果状语

launching her image as a glamorous public persona in London:

a convent-educated rebel who befriended Hollywood stars (同位语)

while writing novels, biographies, plays and poetry.

同位语 (说明 persona 的具体内容)

a convent-educated rebel who befriended Hollywood stars (定语从句)

while writing novels, biographies, plays and poetry.

定语从句 (修饰 a convent-educated rebel)

who befriended Hollywood stars while writing novels,

主语

谓语

宾语

时间状语

biographies, plays and poetry.

(para.5) “In Ireland people want a narrative which emphasises the progressive journey, as if she planned all the political progress on the back of an envelope. ““在爱尔兰，人们想要一种强调进步历程的叙事，就好像她匆匆策划了所有政治进步一样。”

on the back of an envelope 是一个俗语，表示“in a hurried way, without much detail“ 意思是”粗略地，匆忙地“。例如：The prices were very roughly calculated - it looked as though he'd done them on the back of an envelope. 计算出的价格不很精确——看上去似乎他只是粗略算了一下。

其他与“on the back“ 相关的有趣习语有：

on the back of something idiom soon after an earlier success, and as a result of it 由于（不久前的某项成就）

The advertising agency secured the contract on the back of its previous successful campaigns. 由于前期的宣传工作富有成效，这家广告公司最终获得了该合同。

on the back of someone/something idiom by using or taking advantage of someone or something else 利用，借...的光

They have carried on their business operations by riding on the back of established firms. 他们一直在借知名企业的光做他们的生意。

on the back burner idiom If something is on the back burner, it is temporarily not being dealt with or considered, especially because it is not urgent or important （尤指因不紧急或不重要而）暂时搁置一边

We've all had to put our plans on the back burner for a while. 我们大家都只好把计划暂时搁置一段时间。